

AAILEEN SARWAR SYED

Chicago, IL | aaileenuni@gmail.com | [linkedin.com/in/aaileensyed](https://www.linkedin.com/in/aaileensyed)

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Cybersecurity graduate student and early-career Network/IT professional with hands-on experience supporting LAN/WAN troubleshooting, Cisco router/switch environments, DNS/DHCP, VPN, firewall concepts, endpoint protection, PRTG monitoring, VMware labs, and enterprise support workflows. Experienced in documenting incidents, root-cause findings, configuration logic, monitoring evidence, and escalation steps for technical and management audiences. AI enthusiast with completed Claude 101 certification, AI-security project experience, and active participation in Google's Search Priority User Program, evaluating emerging AI-powered Search and digital discovery experiences. Brings strong communication, collaboration, public speaking, and presentation skills through IT support, technical projects, TEDxLewis University, campus leadership, and product feedback work. Currently pursuing CCNA and Security+.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Networking: TCP/IP, LAN/WAN, VLANs, subnetting, routing/switching, L2/L3 concepts, Cisco routers/switches, DNS, DHCP, VPN, OSPF/BGP/EIGRP fundamentals

Security & Monitoring: Firewall rule logic, IDS/IPS concepts, least privilege, access control, Sophos, Webroot, PRTG, OpenVAS, Nessus exposure, Snort exposure

Infrastructure & Systems: Windows 10/11, macOS, Linux Ubuntu/Kali, VMware, VirtualBox, Microsoft 365, Outlook, Teams, remote desktop, endpoint troubleshooting

Cloud & Automation: AWS/Azure networking exposure, PowerShell, Python, SQL, Git/GitHub, documentation, change tracking, technical presentations

Analysis Tools: Wireshark, Zeek concepts, Nmap, Excel, Power BI, Pandas, Matplotlib,

AI Tools: Google AI Studio, Claude 101, AI-powered search evaluation, product feedback, prompt engineering

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Analyst Intern | eFusion Solutions | Hoffman Estates, IL (Remote) | Oct 2022 - Jan 2023

- Resolved 30+ weekly support tickets involving Windows systems, applications, remote access, VPN connectivity, endpoint security alerts, and network troubleshooting.
- Assisted with Cisco router/switch troubleshooting, LAN connectivity validation, IP assignments, DNS, DHCP, VPN, firewall logic, and remote desktop support across client environments.
- Configured and monitored 15+ client environments using PRTG, Sophos, and Webroot to support uptime, endpoint visibility, alert review, and infrastructure reliability.
- Retrieved and reviewed monitoring evidence, endpoint alerts, and troubleshooting logs to document incidents, root-cause findings, escalation notes, and resolution steps.
- Supported senior network administrators during network deployments, workstation setups, remote configuration, and structured escalation/change workflows.
- Built VMware virtual lab environments and presented weekly technical findings, issue summaries, and documentation updates to internal stakeholders.

Graduate Assistant | Office of Community Engagement and Experiential Learning, Lewis University | Romeoville, IL | Jan 2025 – May 2026

- Support multi-user academic and operational systems for 200+ students each semester, including records, data accuracy, reporting, access guidance, and process troubleshooting.
- Troubleshoot access, connectivity, platform, and workflow issues while documenting procedures and escalating when needed for operational consistency.
- Maintain Collaboratory records and the Master Course List, improving tracking accuracy, documentation quality, and accessibility for staff and students.
- Design bi-weekly Constant Contact newsletters and lead onboarding/reflection sessions, increasing partner engagement by 30% and participation by 60%.

Google Search Priority User Program Participant | Google | Remote | Apr 2025 - Present

- Selected for a Google user research and feedback program focused on emerging AI-powered Search features, digital discovery experiences, and large-scale information systems.
- Evaluate new functionalities, test AI-driven experiences, and share product feedback on usability, relevance, user behavior, and search experience quality.
- Collaborate through structured feedback to help product teams improve future search products while representing a diverse user perspective in AI and UX innovation.

UI/UX Design Intern | Ikigai: The Art of Living | Hyderabad, India | May 2022 - Jul 2022

- Co-designed website UI using Figma and improved clarity, accessibility, and navigation through usability testing and competitor analysis.

SELECTED NETWORK AND SECURITY EXPERIENCE

- Performed packet analysis using Wireshark to evaluate TCP, HTTP, DNS behavior, connection patterns, and network troubleshooting evidence.
- Supported ticketing workflows by documenting incidents, troubleshooting steps, root-cause findings, and resolutions for hardware, software, access, endpoint, and network-related issues.

- Used Linux-based virtual machines, Windows tools, and PowerShell scripting for course-based tasks, cybersecurity labs, and CTF competition workflows.
- Practiced least-privilege configurations, firewall rule logic, explicit allow rules, default-deny security posture, detection workflows, documentation, and escalation.
- Worked under network administrators while gaining exposure to Cisco networking, AWS and Azure cloud environments, virtualized infrastructure, and structured change/escalation procedures.

PROJECTS

AI-Assisted Firewall Rule and Network Security Policy Generator | Lewis University

- Built an educational security tool that converts plain-English server/network requirements into Linux iptables firewall rules using a default-deny model.
- Generated explicit allow rules for SSH, HTTP, HTTPS, and ICMP while explaining risk level, business purpose, and least-privilege reasoning.
- Flagged risky configurations such as broad SSH exposure and demonstrated how business requirements can be translated into technical security controls.

Authenticate AI - Long-Range Attention for Deepfake Detection

- Built a YOLOv5/CNN deepfake detection model with long-range attention, achieving 92% detection accuracy on 10,000+ images.

Blockchain Technique for Decentralized Cloud Environments

- Designed a decentralized file storage system using Ethereum smart contracts, SHA-256 hashing, and IPFS integration to improve storage reliability.

CYBERSECURITY COMPETITIONS, LEADERSHIP AND COMMUNITY

- 3rd Place, Advanced Track - Capture the Flame CTF, University of Illinois Chicago, Apr 2026; competed in practical cybersecurity challenges covering forensics, analysis, OSINT, and security problem solving.
- National Cyber League / Cyber Skyline - ranked 466 out of 6,981 nationally; participated in team and individual competitions focused on practical security skills.
- TEDxLewis University 2026 Speaker - delivered a talk on international student hiring barriers, communication, and opportunity.
- President - Girls Who Code Lewis Chapter, 2025 - Present: organize coding workshops, security/networking fundamentals sessions, speaker-led events, and weekly co-working/networking hours.

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

- Master of Science in Cybersecurity | Lewis University | Expected May 2026 | GPA: 3.9/4.0
- Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science Engineering | JNTU, Hyderabad, India | May 2024 | Graduated with Honors
- Certifications: Claude 101 Certification; IBM Introduction to Hardware and Operating Systems; Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate modules; Data Analyst Certificate - Fullstack Academy
- In Progress: Cisco CCNA, CompTIA Security+